EXAMPLE, fictional site

Site study: Fictional site

What each MW of this site earns per day in three paths, from the public model at github.com/Hoblayerta/mw-index, plus public filings where marked. Model output from public averages, not a forecast and not an offer.

20 MW	$50/MWh	27 J/TH	1.3
Site power	Power price	Fleet efficiency	PUE for AI load

Own cash per MW moved to AI: $1.76M to $2.41M before first rent (20% of capex $1.23M to $1.69M, 3-month reserve $0.25M to $0.34M, interest during construction $0.27M to $0.37M, mining given up $17,642 to $17,642; 10-year loan at 10%, favorable to unfavorable case, page 2). For 20 MW all to AI: $35.20M to $48.27M.

Who could put up that cash instead, with public examples:

- **The tenant, as a JV partner.** TeraWulf's Abernathy JV: TeraWulf 50.1% (can rise to 51%), Fluidstack 49.9% (Oct 2025). The deck does not say how much equity each puts in.
- **A GPU host's capital arm.** Hydra Capital: $15M to $250M+, JV "from as little as 5% down"; no published offtake or tier rules.
- **Convertible-note investors.** Blockfusion (50 MW): term sheet for $175M of convertible notes with Sona Asset Management, on a non-binding LOI (TheEnergyMag, 1 Jul 2026).
- **The operator's own bitcoin.** PowerCompute (26 MW) borrowed from Arch against 307 BTC, closed by selling 267.3 BTC (8-K, 30 Sep 2026).
- A backstop like Google's on TeraWulf's and Cipher's Fluidstack leases supports the tenant's rent, which helps the debt, but it is not equity.

Missing: No source shows anyone putting up the 20% for a 5 to 50 MW site without a signed tenant, or a tenant prepaying rent to fund the build.

THREE PATHS, USD PER DAY

Path and basis	Per MW	Whole site	Capex per grid MW	Capex, whole site	Simple payback
Keep mining Hashprice Sep 2026: $39.33/PH/day. Net of power.	**$257**	**$5,133**	$0.85M to build a mine (model reference), already spent on an existing site. Fleet refresh: **Not in model: ASIC price per TH**	$17.00M (reference)	**Not found: needs ASIC price per TH**
Host AI for a tenant $1.85M per MW of IT per year (TeraWulf / Fluidstack). Power is passed through to the tenant, so no power cost is subtracted.	**$3,899**	**$77,977**	$6.15M to $8.46M: $8M to $11M per MW of critical IT (TeraWulf, Cipher filings) divided by PUE	$123.08M to $169.23M	**4.3 to 5.9 years**
Own GPUs (H100) 569 H100 per grid MW at $2.81/h (Oct 2026), 71% utilization. Net of power.	**$26,056**	**$521,123**	$20.00M (CoinShares Q4 2025, in the model; source does not say per MW of IT or grid)	$400.00M	**2.1 years**

Mining and owned GPUs are net of power. Hosting carries no power cost because the tenant pays it in TeraWulf's Fluidstack lease (Cipher's release does not say). Simple payback = capex per MW / (net USD per MW per day x 365). It does not include depreciation, financing, staff, site operating costs or tenant risk.

MINING, LAST 8 MONTHS WITH DATA (NET USD PER MW PER DAY)

Feb 2026	Mar 2026	Apr 2026	May 2026	Jun 2026	Jul 2026	Aug 2026	Sep 2026
-$3	**-$42**	**$56**	**$156**	**-$75**	**-$44**	**$83**	**$257**
hp $32.31	hp $31.27	hp $33.92	hp $36.60	hp $30.37	hp $31.21	hp $34.63	hp $39.33

4 of 8 months at or below zero for this fleet and power price. Break-even hashprice: **$32.40/PH/day**. Range over the 8 months: -$75 to $257 per MW per day.

MIXING MINING AND AI HOSTING ON THIS SITE, USD PER DAY, WHOLE SITE

MW split	Net, Sep 2026	Worst of 8 months	Months at or below 0	Under lease	AI capex (hosting)	Your cash
20 mining / 0 AI	**$5,133**	**-$1,504**	**4 of 8**	**0%**	none	none
15 mining / 5 AI	**$23,344**	**$18,366**	**0 of 8**	**47%**	$30.77M to $42.31M	$8.80M to $12.07M
10 mining / 10 AI	**$41,555**	**$38,237**	**0 of 8**	**73%**	$61.54M to $84.62M	$17.60M to $24.14M
5 mining / 15 AI	**$59,766**	**$58,107**	**0 of 8**	**89%**	$92.31M to $126.92M	$26.40M to $36.21M
0 mining / 20 AI	**$77,977**	**$77,977**	**0 of 8**	**100%**	$123.08M to $169.23M	$35.20M to $48.27M

Each split uses the same 8 months as above: mining MW earn that month's net, AI MW earn the hosting rate. Revenue under lease = hosting revenue / (hosting revenue + mining revenue before power), Sep 2026. Your cash before first rent: as in the financing table below, 10-year term at 10%. Assumes the grid connection splits freely between the two loads; interconnection and finding the tenant are not in the model.

FINANCING THE AI PART AND WHEN IT PAYS BACK, PER GRID MW MOVED TO AI

Answer for this site: each MW moved to AI needs about $1.76M of your cash before first rent and gives it back in 82 months (6.8 yr) from signing, on 10-year loan at 10%, only in the favorable case (low capex, 85% margin). On a 5-year loan the rent does not cover the payment. How many of the 20 MW go to AI is set by your cash: MW = your cash / $1.76M or more.

Months with no AI income: **12 of construction** from signing to first rent, then the tenant ramps over **6 months** to full rent ($118,590 per MW per month).

Loan term and rate	Your cash before first rent	DSCR, first year at full rent	Meets 1.15x?	Your cash back, from signing
5 years at 10%	$1.88M to $2.58M	**0.87x to 0.52x**	no	96 months (8.0 yr) to 151 months (12.6 yr)
5 years at 15%	$2.08M to $2.85M	**0.76x to 0.46x**	no	104 months (8.7 yr) to 165 months (13.8 yr)
10 years at 10%	$1.76M to $2.41M	**1.29x to 0.77x**	only favorable	82 months (6.8 yr) to 170 months (14.2 yr)
10 years at 15%	$1.95M to $2.68M	**1.04x to 0.62x**	no	112 months (9.3 yr) to 194 months (16.2 yr)

Default structure from USD.AI: loan = 80% of capex, you put 20% plus a 3-month debt-service reserve, equal monthly principal from first rent, 1.15x minimum coverage. USD.AI lends 3 to 5 years against GPUs, not buildings; 10 years is the base term of the TeraWulf and Cipher hosting leases. Rates 10% to 15%: what USD.AI charged smaller operators (American Compute, Oct 2026). Ranges run from favorable (low capex, 85% NOI margin) to unfavorable (high capex, 70% NOI margin). Your cash before first rent = 20% of capex + 3-month reserve + interest during construction + mining given up during construction. Below 1.0x the rent does not cover the payment and you add cash every month until the loan is paid; the payback counts that. Construction 12 months: Cipher signed Barber Lake on 25 Sep 2025 with rent from Oct 2026; TeraWulf signed on 14 Aug 2025 and delivered CB-3 in early Jul 2026, and its CB-5 slipped from 2H 2026 to early 2027. Ramp 6 months: TeraWulf's plan, 40 of 200 MW in 1H 2026 and all by year-end. These are large public operators; a 20 MW site has no public benchmark. Interest during construction assumes the loan is drawn evenly over the 12 months and interest is paid monthly (no source for a small site's draw schedule). The AI MW stop mining at signing and give up $48 per MW per day, the average of the last 8 months. Rent is net of site costs: NOI margin 85% (TeraWulf, Cipher) to ~70% (TeraWulf Abernathy, average over lease life); NOI = rent less property operating expenses, property taxes and insurance. Not included: income taxes, depreciation, and the reserve coming back at the end.

WHO PAYS FOR THE BUILD, PER GRID MW MOVED TO AI

Structure	Your cash before first rent	You net per month, first year at full rent
You build it (10-year loan at 10%) Current scenario: you put the equity, the reserve and the interest during construction; you keep all the rent net of site costs.	$1.76M to $2.41M	**$21,211 to -$25,872**
Tenant pays the build (Empery-type triple net lease) You bring the site and its power; the tenant pays the build-out and operating costs. Rent = $440M / 15 years / 150 MW = $16,296 per MW per month (Empery does not say if MW are gross or IT).	none	**$14,826**
Joint venture with the tenant (Abernathy-type, you 50.1%) Bonds of $7.74M per MW of IT at 7.25% cover most of the $8.00M to $10.00M build; you put 50.1% of the rest and get 50.1% of NOI after interest. Bond principal payments not public: treated as interest-only (assumed).	$0.10M to $0.87M	**$30,215**
Preferred equity covers your cash (Macquarie-type) $2.25M per leased MW (taken as MW of IT) at 12.75% a year replaces your cash; Macquarie also took 15% of the common equity and required a signed lease.	$29,437 to $0.68M	**$2,822 to -$44,261**

Net per month is after debt service or preferred dividend and after the mining income those MW give up ($1,470 per MW per month, last 8 months). Ranges: favorable to unfavorable case. Each structure comes from one public deal at a large site; none is offered to a 5 to 50 MW site in the sources found.

Assumptions. Mining puts all 20 MW on ASICs at 27 J/TH (37.0 PH/s per MW, no cooling overhead), revenue = hashprice x PH/s, minus 24 MWh/day at your tariff. AI paths use IT load = 1/PUE of each grid MW; 740 H100 per MW of IT (from NVIDIA DGX H100 specs); 71% utilization (Epoch); hosting rate $1.85M per MW of IT per year (TeraWulf / Fluidstack). Mine and GPU capex per MW from CoinShares Q4 2025 (in the model); hosting capex from TeraWulf and Cipher filings (not in the model). Fees are inside hashprice.

Sources. Hashprice: Luxor Hashrate Index monthly lookbacks (7 pages), Sep 2026 from a secondary summary (asic.tools). H100: https://uvik.net/blog/gpu-price-index/ (mixed index; H100 points mix marketplace, contract and index prices). Each row's URL is in github.com/Hoblayerta/mw-index/data. Series compiled 19 Oct 2026. Hosting capex and power terms, read 2 Nov 2026: TeraWulf, Fluidstack deal, 14 Aug 2025: $8-10M per MW of critical IT load, modified gross lease (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1083301/000110465925078084/tm2523008d2_ex99-1.htm). TeraWulf, Abernathy JV deck, Oct 2025: $8-10M per critical MW, "Power 100% passed-through to tenant" (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001083301/000110465925102858/tm2529509d1_ex99-3.htm). Cipher, Fluidstack deal, 25 Sep 2025: $9-11M per MW of critical IT load, modified gross lease, power terms not stated (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1819989/000095010325012168/dp234624_ex9901.htm). Debt, construction, ramp and site costs, read 4 Nov 2026: USD.AI underwriting: 80% of deployment cost, 20% equity, 3 to 5 years with equal monthly principal, 3-month debt-service reserve, 1.15x DSCR; finances GPUs in Tier III/IV sites (https://usd.ai/blog/usdai-underwriting-and-risk-management). American Compute, GPU loan spreads and interest rates, updated 10 Oct 2026: onchain loans to smaller operators 10.00-15.00% (observed public prices, not quotes) (https://www.amcompute.com/gpu-debt/pricing). TeraWulf, 14 Aug 2025: 10-year Fluidstack leases, phase one ~40 MW online 1H 2026, full 200+ MW by year-end 2026 (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1083301/000110465925078084/tm2523008d2_ex99-1.htm). TeraWulf Q2 2026 results, 5 Aug 2026: CB-3 delivered early July 2026; CB-4 phased rent in 2H 2026; CB-5 slipped to early 2027 (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001083301/000108330126000162/a_wulfearningsreleaseq22026.htm). Cipher business update, 24 Feb 2026: Barber Lake (Fluidstack, signed 25 Sep 2025) 10-year lease, start Oct 2026 (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1819989/000181998926000007/cipherdigital_businessup.htm). Site costs as NOI margin (rent less property operating expenses, property taxes and insurance): TeraWulf 14 Aug 2025, 85%; Cipher 25 Sep 2025, 80-85%; TeraWulf Abernathy JV deck Oct 2025, ~70% average over lease life (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001083301/000110465925102858/tm2529509d1_ex99-3.htm). Who could put up the cash: The tenant, as a JV partner (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001083301/000110465925102858/tm2529509d1_ex99-3.htm). A GPU host's capital arm (https://hydrahost.com/financing/). Convertible-note investors (https://www.theenergymag.com/news/2026-07-01/blockfusion-ai-bitcoin-spac). The operator's own bitcoin (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001640384/000119312526408391/lmfa-ex99_1.htm). Who pays for the build, read 5 Nov 2026: Empery Digital proxy, Sep 2026: $65M for 25% of a 150 MW Midwest site; detailed LOI for a triple net lease, tenant funds all build-out and operating costs; payments of more than $440M over 15 years from early 2027 (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0001829794/000168316826007266/empery_defa14a.htm). TeraWulf, Abernathy JV, Oct 2025: TeraWulf 50.1%, Fluidstack 49.9%; 168 MW of critical IT; ~$9.5B of rent over 25 years; ~$260M average annual site NOI; build cost $8-10M per critical MW; $1.3B of bonds at 7.25% (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1083301/000110465925102858/tm2529509d1_8k.htm). Applied Digital 8-K, Jan 2025: Macquarie invests $2.25M per MW of leased capacity in perpetual preferred units at 12.75%, minimum 1.80x multiple, plus 15% of the HPC business's common equity; requires an executed lease (https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1144879/000149315225002040/form8-k.htm).

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